

Tuesday, 4 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Drizzle	Drizzle	Showers
29° 21°	27° 19°	26° 18°	20° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

England and Wales have just experienced their driest July on record, with many parts of the UK enjoying exceptionally warm and sunny weather.

The Met Office confirmed the figures, highlighting a significant lack of rainfall across both nations. While great for summer activities, it does raise concerns about water levels.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

At least five survivors of alleged exploitation by the Al Fayed family have now been officially confirmed as modern slavery victims.

These rulings include women trafficked both internationally and within the UK. One particularly shocking case was found to have taken place entirely within the iconic Harrods department store.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A man has admitted to Greek police that he transported the body of a Scottish woman in a suitcase.

He has been arrested on suspicion of manslaughter, as well as robbery and weapons offences. The investigation into the tragic death is ongoing.

CRIME · UK
- 4

The Conservatives are calling for a significant increase in the use of facial recognition technology by police forces.

They propose that all images of suspects should be routinely run through facial recognition software. This move aims to enhance law enforcement capabilities but also sparks privacy debates.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

In a medical first for Britain, a baby has undergone pioneering womb surgery to correct a rare condition where its intestines were growing outside its body.

Baby Theo was part of a clinical trial for complex gastroschisis, marking a huge step forward in fetal medicine. Both mother and baby are now recovering well.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The new Spider-Man film, 'Brand New Day', has just swung into cinemas, enjoying the second-biggest global opening weekend ever.**

Fans are already hailing Tom Holland's latest web-slinging performance as his best yet. It's a huge boost for Disney, with the highly anticipated 'Avengers: Doomsday' still to come.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Spider-Man films? What makes Tom Holland's portrayal so popular?

FILM · NOW
- 2 British girl band FLO are making waves, confidently declaring they 'want it all' as they prepare for their second album.**

The rising stars say making 'Therapy at the Club' was a 'crash course' in the music industry. They're definitely ones to watch!

ON AIR – Who are your favourite new British music acts making a name for themselves?

MUSIC · SOON
- 3 Sam Fender and Olivia Dean's duet 'Rein Me In' has broken a 73-year-old UK singles chart record.**

The track has now spent an incredible 19 non-consecutive weeks at the top of the charts. It's a phenomenal achievement for both artists!

ON AIR – What's a song that you just can't get enough of at the moment? One that you've had on repeat for weeks!

MUSIC · NOW
- 4 More and more Love Island fans are choosing to watch the US edition, saying the contestants 'actually fancy each other'!**

Commentators and even former Islanders are reflecting on what the UK dating series could do to draw in more viewers. Perhaps a little more genuine romance, less drama?

ON AIR – Do you still watch Love Island? What do you think the UK version could do to make it more engaging?

TV · NOW
- 5 Motown legend Diana Ross penned a 'special song' for the huge Pride crowd, telling them to 'always be you'.**

The 82-year-old icon, a huge favourite with the LGBTQ+ community, delivered a powerful message during her performance. A truly heartwarming moment.

ON AIR – What's a song that always makes you feel good and proud to be yourself?

MUSIC · RECENTLY

On the schedule

- 1 Rashid Khan was on fire, taking a five-wicket haul to lead MI London to a dominant victory over the Manchester Super Giants.**

MI London defeated their rivals by 45 runs, moving them up to second in the Men's Hundred table. It was a thrilling performance!

ON AIR – Are you following The Hundred this year? Which team are you backing to win?

CRICKET · UK
- 2 Ben Duckett inspired Trent Rockets to a five-run victory over Sunrisers Leeds, keeping them top of the Men's Hundred table.**

The Rockets secured their fourth win of the tournament at Trent Bridge, maintaining their strong start. Duckett's performance was key to their success.

ON AIR – Who's been your player of the tournament so far in The Hundred?

CRICKET · UK
- 3 Newcastle United have strengthened their squad, signing goalkeeper Lukas Hornicek from Braga for £25.7 million.**

This significant transfer shows Newcastle's ambition as they look to build for the new season. Hornicek will be hoping to make a big impact.

ON AIR – Which Premier League team do you think has made the best signing so far this transfer window?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Como have agreed a deal worth over £30 million to sign Chelsea defender Trevoh Chalobah.**

It's a big move for Chalobah as he heads to Italy. This transfer will provide Chelsea with funds to potentially bring in new players.

ON AIR – Which player do you think will be the biggest transfer saga of the summer?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 St Johnstone edged out Kilmarnock in a thrilling seven-goal Scottish Premiership match at McDiarmid Park.**

Fans were treated to an absolute goal-fest as both teams battled it out. St Johnstone ultimately secured the win in a memorable game.

ON AIR – What's the most exciting football match you've ever seen, with goals flying in?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Many are rediscovering the joy of 'slow travel', taking trains and buses to appreciate the journey as much as the destination.**
This mindful approach allows for unexpected discoveries and a more relaxed pace, avoiding the rush of traditional holidays.
- 2 The trend of 'upcycling old furniture' is not just eco-friendly but also a fantastic way to add unique character to your home.**
Giving a tired piece a new lease of life with a lick of paint or some creative upholstery is proving very popular.
- 3 A surge in 'outdoor swimming' in rivers and lakes is being reported, with enthusiasts enjoying the refreshing benefits for both body and mind.**
It's a invigorating way to connect with nature, though always remember to swim safely and be aware of local conditions.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'writing and sending postcards' is making a charming comeback in our digital age.**
Receiving a handwritten note from a holiday or special occasion offers a lovely, personal touch that emails just can't quite capture.
- 5 Experts are suggesting that 'spending time observing local wildlife', even in urban areas, can significantly reduce stress.**
Just a few minutes watching birds in the garden or squirrels in the park can provide a wonderful sense of calm and connection.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for 'traditional board games', with families and friends opting for unplugged fun evenings.**
Classic games are making a big return, offering a great way to socialise and enjoy some screen-free entertainment together.
- 7 The unexpected delight of 'discovering new local walking routes' is becoming a favourite pastime for many.**
Exploring hidden paths and scenic trails right on your doorstep can reveal a whole new perspective of your familiar surroundings.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're tidying up, even though we know it's probably not the most efficient way?

ANSWER: HIDING THINGS IN A 'MYSTERY CUPBOARD' TO DEAL WITH LATER.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of pizza. What is it?

ANSWER: WAVING IT AROUND A LITTLE TO COOL IT DOWN, EVEN IF IT'S ONLY JUST COME OUT OF THE BOX.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or place?**
What's that one smell, good or bad, that immediately sparks a vivid memory for you, and what's the story behind it?

- **Think about those 'little household quirks' that only make sense in your own home.**
Is there a particular gadget, a wonky shelf, or a unique way of doing something in your house that visitors always find a bit baffling?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them find the sweetest nectar.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- The average person walks the equivalent of five times around the world in their lifetime.
- A 'butt' is an actual unit of measurement for wine, equal to two hogsheads or 126 gallons.
- The humble teabag was accidentally invented in 1908 by a New York tea merchant sending samples in silk pouches.
- The first ever webcam was created at Cambridge University to monitor a coffee pot.
- It is illegal to sing in public in Florida while wearing a swimsuit.
- The 'king' of a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.

On this day

Day 216 of the year, 149 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aristarchus; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Cesarini; Christian feast day: Euphronius; Christian feast day: Blessed Frédéric Janssoone. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Robbin Crosby, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2002)
- 1957 — John Wark, Scottish footballer and sportscaster
- 1992 — Cole Sprouse, American actor
- 1968 — Lee Mack, English comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — Timi Yuro, American singer-songwriter (died 2004)
- 1970 — John August, American director and screenwriter
- 1941 — Cliff Nobles, American musician (died 2008)
- 1992 — Dylan Sprouse, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — A massacre is carried out by Sri Lankan government forces, killing 17 employees of the French INGO Action Against Hunger (known internationally as Action Contre la Faim, or ACF).
- 1995 — Operation Storm, the last major battle of the Croatian War of Independence begins.
- 2020 — Beirut Port explosion: At least 220 people are killed and over 5,000 are wounded when 2,700 tons of ammonium nitrate explodes in Beirut, Lebanon.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1984 — The Ariane 3 rocket is launched for the first time, carrying the Eutelsat I F-2 and Télécom 1A satellites into geosynchronous transfer orbit.
- 2007 — NASA's Phoenix Mars lander is launched.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1924 — Diplomatic relations between Mexico and the Soviet Union are established.
- 1965 — The Constitution of the Cook Islands comes into force, giving the Cook Islands self-governing status within New Zealand.

- 1977 — U.S. President Jimmy Carter signs legislation creating the United States Department of Energy.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 217 of the year, 148 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abel of Reims; Christian feast day: Addai; Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Cassian of Autun. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Michael Walsh, English footballer
- 1979 — David Healy, Irish footballer
- 2008 — Hudson Meek, American actor (died 2024)
- 1946 — Erika Slezak, American actress
- 1980 — Jesse Williams, American actor, director, producer, and political activist
- 1956 — Maureen McCormick, American actress
- 1943 — Sammi Smith, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1965 — Jeff Coffin, American saxophonist and composer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Cold War: The United States, the United Kingdom, and the Soviet Union sign the Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.
- 2010 — The Copiapó mining accident occurs, trapping 33 Chilean miners approximately 2,300 ft (700 m) below the ground for 69 days.
- 1984 — A Biman Bangladesh Airlines Fokker F27 Friendship crashes on approach to Zia International Airport, in Dhaka, Bangladesh, killing all 49 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1957 — American Bandstand, a show dedicated to the teenage "baby-boomers" by playing the songs and showing popular dances of the time, debuts on the ABC television network.
- 2024 — Following the non-cooperation movement against the government of Bangladesh, Bangladeshi prime minister Sheikh Hasina resigns and flees the country, ending her rule of 15 consecutive years and a total of almost two decades. The date is also known as 36 July.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)